

AI OPERATIONS

The expert did not get replaced.

AI entered the review loop. Their job changed.

Here is where the judgment went.

AI speeds pattern-finding. It does not know which pattern is dangerous.

- The model flags anomalies consistently at scale.
- It has no idea which flagged item ends up on the front page of a trade publication.
- That judgment did not get automated. It got concentrated.

This is where the expert went.

THE TWO COLUMNS

Map where failure is cheap versus expensive.

LEFT COLUMN

Cheap + Reversible

AI review is the right call. High volume.
Repeatable. Let the model own it.

RIGHT COLUMN

Expensive + Public

The expert has to be positioned here on purpose. Not as a rubber stamp.

The expert lives in the second column.

THE DESIGN FLAW

Most teams run AI across all of it and route exceptions to whoever is available.

The gap:

The person who is available and the person who owns the right-column judgment are not always the same person.

Not a model problem. A design flaw.

THE WEIRD CHECKS

The model flags what it knows to look for.

The weird check is outside that set.

A combination of factors the model had no reason to weight together. A history with this failure type that no training set has because it happened once, in one specific context.

There is no automated path to it.

This is the job the experienced person now owns.

Not a smaller job. A different one.

MAKING IT VISIBLE

Have the expert narrate the last five times they caught something AI would have cleared.

- What they noticed. Why it concerned them. What they checked next.
- Not to teach the AI those checks. To make the checks visible enough that the organization knows they exist and knows who holds them.

A visible expertise map beats a vague promise that AI reviews the work.

THE EXPERTISE MAP

One page. Three columns. Per review layer you have deployed.

Review task

Failure cost (cheap/reversible or expensive/public)

Who owns the weird checks in that row

This is a redeployment of scarce judgment. Not a headcount cut.

full/REFIT

Get the Expertise Map worksheet.

Two-column grid. Names who owns the weird checks once AI handles the routine work. Twenty minutes to fill in for any review layer you have already deployed.

Get the free worksheet

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